

ALL IN THE FAMILY

Among the appointments in the new Uttar Pradesh BJP state executive, the one that drew the most attention was that of Neeraj Singh, younger son of defence minister Rajnath Singh. The 44-year-old was named state vice-president in the 46-member committee, marking his first major organisational role. Until now, he has not even held a significant district-level post in the party, hence the raised eyebrows. Neeraj is the third member—elder brother, Pankaj Singh, is the party MLA from Noida—from the family to enter active politics. Within the BJP, the University of Leeds graduate has long been seen as Rajnath's 'informal representative', managing links with the party organisation and administration in Lucknow when his father is in Delhi. After the appointment, Neeraj also posted a 24-year-old photograph of his from a 2002 BJP campaign, possibly to nix any talk of nepotism.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ NEW DIGS FOR DKS

HOME REMEDIES

Karnataka chief minister **D.K. Shivakumar** has chosen the historic Kumara Krupa guesthouse in Bengaluru as his official residence, instead of moving into 'Anugraha', the designated CM bungalow that many leaders now regard as 'jinxed' (after a number of previous occupants suffered political reverses). Renovation work is under way at the 160-year-old, 12-room bungalow on Kumara Krupa Road, once the residence of Mysore diwan K. Seshadri Iyer and the place where Mahatma Gandhi stayed during an extended visit in 1927. PWD officials say the revamp, including a separate approach road and boundary wall, will follow DKS's vaastu preferences, with work expected to be completed around Dussehra. The Opposition JD(S) has criticised the alteration of a heritage building for personal convenience, though officials insist its character will be preserved.

